



METRO BLUE LINE TO SERVE OVER 1M PEOPLE

■ THE NEW LINE SPANS 30KM AND COMPRISES 14 STATIONS

■ EMAAR PROPERTIES STATION TO BE THE WORLD'S HIGHEST

■ DUBAI'S RAIL NETWORK WILL EXPAND TO A TOTAL OF 131KM

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

Dubai Metro Blue Line will serve nine districts with a projected population exceeding a million people.

This was revealed yesterday after His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE, and Ruler of Dubai, attended the foundation stone laying ceremony of the Dubai Metro Blue Line, a key milestone in the expansion of the city's public transportation network.

Spanning 30km and comprising 14 stations, the new line is set to transform mobility across nine key districts, projected to be home to over one million residents, as outlined in the Dubai 2040 Urban Master Plan.

Distinctive design

Shaikh Mohammad also approved the distinctive architectural design of the iconic Emaar Properties Station, the highest metro station in the world, standing at 74 metres.

The station is designed to integrate harmoniously into the existing urban environment and embodies the vision of 'Dubai: A Gateway to the Future'. Covering an area of approximately 11,000 square metres, the station is designed to accommodate up to 160,000 passengers per day, with the number of daily users expected to exceed 70,000 by 2040. With the completion of the Blue Line project, Dubai's rail network will expand



WAM

■ Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid is briefed by Mattar Al Tayer during the foundation stone laying ceremony of the Dubai Metro Blue Line yesterday.

to a total of 131km, comprising 78 stations and 168 trains. Mattar Al Tayer, Director General, Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of the Roads and Transport Authority, briefed Shaikh Mohammad on the expansion of metro services, including the growth in ridership, station design, number of stations, and train carriages. The Dubai Metro has transported over 2.527 billion passengers from its launch on 9/9/2009 through the end of 2024. The Metro recorded a daily average of 900,000 passengers in 2024.

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METRO BLUE LINE: WHAT WE KNOW

- The Blue Line will span a total length of 30km, with 15.5km running underground and 14.5km above ground.
- With its 14 stations, including key interchange points like the Creek Station on the Green Line, Centrepoint Station on the Red Line, and Dubai International City Station 1, along with the iconic station at Dubai Creek Harbour, the Blue Line is set to be a pivotal element in the ongoing development of the city's transportation network.
- The new line is a key integration point between the Red and Green Lines of Dubai Metro.
- The Blue Line will offer a direct connection between Dubai International Airport and nine key areas along the line namely Mirdif, Al Warqa, International City 1 and 2, Dubai Silicon Oasis, Academic City, Ras Al Khor Industrial Area, Dubai Creek Harbour and Dubai Festival City.

—Khitam Al Amir, Chief News Editor

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Israel blocks Thunberg's Gaza-bound aid ship

JERUSALEM

Israel intercepted a humanitarian aid ship en route to Gaza that was carrying activists including Swedish climate advocate Greta Thunberg, and said it would send those on board back to their home nations.

The Freedom Flotilla Coalition, which operates the vessel, said in a statement the boat was forcibly blocked in international waters, its crew "abducted," and the cargo — which included food, baby formula and medical supplies — confiscated.

The ship "is safely making its way to the shores of Israel," Israel's Foreign Ministry said yesterday. "The passengers are safe and were provided with sandwiches and water, and are expected to return to their home countries."

Thunberg's civilian ship set sail from Sicily on June 1.

— Bloomberg
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84,479 red-light violations recorded across UAE in 2024

Light vehicles alone accounted for 82,663 violations

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Jumping red lights continues to be a serious problem on UAE roads. According to a recent report from the Ministry of Interior, a total of 84,479 red-light violations were recorded across the country in 2024.

Police and traffic authorities have repeatedly warned drivers about the dangers of running red lights. Despite their efforts, the numbers remain high, and red-light jumping was one of the leading causes of road accidents last year.

Highest in Abu Dhabi

The UAE Ministry of Interior statistics show that these violations led to 271 traffic incidents nationwide.

Abu Dhabi saw the highest number of such accidents with 153 incidents, followed by 111 in Dubai. Ras Al Khaimah and Umm Al

271
traffic incidents nationwide due to red-light violations

Quwain each reported three cases while Sharjah recorded one incident.

Light vehicles accounted for 82,663 violations, motorcycles 862 violations and heavy vehicles 954 violations.

Under UAE traffic laws, jumping a red light comes with serious consequences. Offenders face a Dh1,000 fine, 12 black points and vehicle impoundment for 30 days.

On top of this, some emirates have stricter local rules. For example:

In Dubai, drivers must pay Dh50,000 to release an impounded vehicle, according to Decree No. 30 of 2023.

In Abu Dhabi, the fine for releasing an impounded vehicle is also Dh50,000 under Law No. 5 of 2020. If the fine isn't paid within three months, the vehicle could be sold at a public auction.

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